AIRCRAFT

Tracker Plus · frequently asked questions · live planes around you, up to 40 nautical miles away

Getting started

What do I need?
Your Tracker Plus, a Wi-Fi network (2.4 GHz; it can't join 5 GHz-only networks) and a USB power supply or computer USB port.

How do I set it up?
Tap Aircraft on the Home screen. The first time, it finds your location from your internet connection and shows it (for example Toronto, Ontario). Tap OK, or Change to type exact numbers.

How do I change the location later?
Home > Settings > Radar location. Type your latitude and longitude, for example 43.65 and -79.38 for Toronto. Keep the minus sign: west and south are negative. Two digits after the dot is plenty.

How do I find my latitude and longitude?
Google Maps on a phone: press and hold on your home until a red pin drops. The two numbers appear in the search bar (first latitude, then longitude). iPhone Maps: press and hold to drop a pin, swipe up on the pin card and scroll to Latitude and Longitude. On a computer: right-click your home at maps.google.com; the top line shows both numbers.

How do I get back to the Home screen?
Tap Home at the bottom right.

Is there a subscription or account?
No. Aircraft positions come from a free public service.

Using it

What am I looking at?
On the left is the radar: you are in the centre, with north at the top and rings every 10 nautical miles out to 40 (about 74 km). Every plane in range is drawn where it is, pointing the way it is flying. The top bar shows how many are in range.

What are the labels next to the planes?
The flight number and the height in hundreds of feet (370 = 37,000 ft). The closest planes get a label; where labels would overlap, some are left off.

What is the panel on the right?
The picked plane (ringed in yellow): its flight or ID, aircraft type, altitude, speed in knots, and distance and direction from you in nautical miles.

What does FL370 mean?
Flight level 370 - 37,000 feet. Planes above 18,000 ft show their height this way; lower ones show it in feet.

How do I pick a plane?
Tap it (or its label) on the radar, or tap Next to step through them, closest first.

How often does it update?
Every 15 seconds, by itself. The sweep line keeps turning in between.

Why do some planes show a code instead of a flight number?
Private planes, helicopters and some cargo flights don't send a flight number. Then it shows the plane's radio ID (a 6-character code).

What is SET for?
It opens Home > Settings (Radar location, Wi-Fi, touch calibration, sound).

Data

Where does the data come from?
adsb.fi (with adsb.lol as backup), free public networks of volunteer receivers that pick up the signals planes send out.

Why are there no planes?
Either no plane is within 40 nautical miles right now (common at night or far from airports), or there is no volunteer receiver near you. The panel then says "No planes in the 40 NM area".

Troubleshooting

Why does it take a while to show data? Please be patient.
After it opens, it downloads the planes around you. The first planes appear within about 15 to 30 seconds. That's normal - it isn't stuck.

It says the radar request failed.
The free plane service didn't answer that time. It tries again every 15 seconds by itself.

The Wi-Fi dropped.
It stays on its screen and carries on when Wi-Fi is back.

Taps land in the wrong place.
Go Home, then Settings > Cal and press the centre of each dot. From the Wi-Fi screen you can also hold the screen for 3 seconds.

It restarted by itself or froze.
Unplug it for 10 seconds and plug it back in. If it keeps happening, contact the seller.

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